HavenMade – Development Journal and QA Testing Notes

Name: Haven Freeman

Course: CSC 4370 – Web Programming

Project: Project 1 – HavenMade

Project Track: Recipe Studio

Project Type: Individual

Part 1: Development Journal

1. Project Planning

For Project 1, I decided to create a recipe website called HavenMade. I wanted to make something that reflected my interest in cooking while also being useful to other people.

My main idea was to create a website with affordable recipes that would be easy for college students and beginner cooks to follow.

I chose a cozy, slightly retro design because I wanted the website to feel welcoming instead of looking like a typical recipe website.

I planned four main pages: Home, Recipes, Recipe Details, and My Story. I also created wireframes to show how I wanted the pages to be organized.

2. Building the Website

I started by creating the HTML files for each page and connecting them through the navigation menu.

The four pages are:

- index.html – Home
- recipes.html – Recipes
- recipe-detail.html – Recipe Details

- about.html – My Story

After creating the pages, I worked on the CSS styling.

I used a color palette with cream, brown, pink, yellow, and green. I also used rounded corners, recipe cards, and spacing to make the website look more organized.

I wanted all four pages to feel like they belonged to the same website, so I used a shared CSS stylesheet.

3. Adding Recipes and Images

I added six recipes to the website:

1. Honey-Glazed Salmon Bowl
2. Chicken Noodle Soup
3. BBQ Chicken Flatbread Pizza
4. Tomato Soup and Grilled Cheese
5. Homestyle Chili
6. Sweet Golden Cornbread

I used my own food photographs for the recipes.

I organized the recipes into cards so visitors could browse the different meals and click to view more information.

I also made sure the images were sized and arranged to fit the website layout.

4. Making the Website Responsive

After building the main layout, I worked on making the website usable on different screen sizes.

I used CSS media queries to adjust the layout for smaller screens.

For example, the recipe cards can change their arrangement depending on the screen width.

I also adjusted the spacing and layout of the interactive sections so they would be easier to use on mobile devices.

5. Adding CSS Animations

I added CSS animations and transitions to make the website feel more interactive.

I wanted the animations to add some personality without distracting visitors from the recipes.

I also included reduced-motion support so users who prefer fewer animations would have a better experience.

6. Bonus Feature: Recipe Recommendation Engine

For my bonus feature, I created a recipe recommendation section on the Recipes page.

Visitors can choose between four options:

- On a Budget
- Something Quick
- Comfort Food
- Something Sweet

When someone selects an option, the website displays a suggested recipe with a short explanation.

I created this using HTML radio buttons and CSS selectors.

This was one of the more challenging parts of the project because I had to make the feature interactive without using JavaScript.

The feature is a CSS-only simulation of a recommendation engine, not an actual AI system.

7. Problems I Encountered

One problem I ran into was getting all my recipe images to display correctly after uploading the website to the CODD server.

Some of the images worked, but others were not loading.

I found that the file permissions needed to be adjusted. After correcting the permissions, I checked the website again and confirmed that all six recipe images displayed.

Another challenge was making the recommendation feature work correctly while keeping the layout responsive.

I made adjustments to the HTML and CSS and tested the different options until the feature worked the way I wanted.

8. GitHub and Project Management

I used GitHub to store my project files and keep track of changes.

I also created a Trello board with five lists:

- Backlog
- To Do
- In Progress
- Review
- Done

I used the board to organize tasks such as building pages, adding styles, testing features, fixing problems, and preparing the final documentation.

Using Trello helped me see what I had already completed and what still needed attention.

9. Final Deployment

After completing the main website, I uploaded the files to the Georgia State University CODD server.

I checked the published website to make sure the pages, links, styles, and images were working.

I also had a friend open the website and test it.

After fixing the image problem and checking the main features, I was satisfied with how the website was functioning.

10. What I Learned

This project helped me get more comfortable working with HTML and CSS.

I learned more about organizing a website with multiple pages, creating responsive layouts, and using CSS to make a website interactive.

I also got more practice using GitHub, working with a university server, and troubleshooting problems.

One thing I learned is that a website can work correctly on my computer but still have problems after it is uploaded to a server.

Overall, I am happy with how HavenMade turned out. I was able to create something that reflects my interests while practicing the skills from this course.

Part 2: Quality Assurance (QA) Testing Notes

1. Purpose of Testing

The purpose of testing was to make sure HavenMade worked correctly and was easy to navigate.

I focused on checking the main pages, recipe links, images, responsive layouts, and the recommendation feature.

2. Testing Results

Test	What I Checked	Result
Homepage	The homepage loads on the published website	Passed
Navigation	Links between the four main pages	Passed
Recipe cards	Recipe links open the correct recipe information	Passed
Images	All six recipe photographs display on CODD	Passed after fixing permissions
CSS styling	The published pages load their styles	Passed
Recommendation feature	Each cooking mood changes the suggested recipe	Passed
Mobile layout	The recommendation section works on a smaller screen	Passed
Keyboard navigation	Recommendation options can be selected using the keyboard	Passed
Peer testing	A friend opened and tested the published website	Passed

3. Responsive Design Testing

I checked how the website behaved at different screen sizes, especially the recipe recommendation section.

The layout was designed to adjust when the screen becomes smaller.

I confirmed that the recommendation options could still be used on a mobile-sized screen.

4. Accessibility Testing

I tested keyboard interaction with the recipe recommendation feature.

I was able to move through the options and select them without relying only on a mouse.

I also included visible focus styling and reduced-motion support in the CSS.

These features were added to make the website easier to use for different visitors.

I did not complete a full automated accessibility audit, so I am not claiming that every accessibility requirement has been verified.

5. Bugs and Fixes

Issue 1: Recipe images were not loading on CODD

Problem: Some food photographs did not appear on the published website.

Cause: The image files needed updated permissions on the server.

Fix: I changed the file and directory permissions, then refreshed the website.

Result: All six recipe photographs displayed correctly.

Issue 2: Recommendation feature needed adjustments

Problem: I needed the suggested recipe to change when visitors selected a different cooking mood.

Fix: I adjusted the HTML radio inputs and CSS selectors used to control the recommendation cards.

Result: All four cooking mood options worked correctly.

6. Peer Feedback

I asked a friend to open the published HavenMade website and test it.

My friend reported that everything they tried was working.

This helped me confirm that the website was accessible from another person's browser and not just my own computer.

7. Final QA Summary

Based on my testing, the main features of HavenMade are working.

The four pages are connected, the recipe links work, the photographs display correctly, and the CSS-only recommendation feature responds to user selections.

The website is published on the CODD server and can be accessed using its public URL.

I completed manual testing, HTML validation, CSS validation, and accessibility audit.

8. Project Links

GitHub Repository:

https://github.com/Hfreeman1/HavenMade

Published Website:

https://codd.cs.gsu.edu/~hfreeman11/HavenMade/

Technologies Used:

HTML5, CSS3, Git, GitHub, Trello, and CODD server

Conclusion

HavenMade gave me the opportunity to practice creating a complete website from planning to deployment.

I was able to build four connected pages, add original recipe content, create a responsive design, and implement an interactive feature using only HTML and CSS.

Testing also helped me find and fix problems that I would not have noticed by only viewing the website locally.